

AIMS Guard Accountability Trigger Framework (ATF)

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A Governance Framework for Human Oversight and High-Risk AI Decisions

Executive Summary:

The increasing adoption of AI-assisted systems is creating new governance challenges across public sector organisations, regulated industries and software development environments.

While many governance frameworks emphasise principles such as accountability, transparency and human oversight, organisations often face difficulties translating those principles into practical controls that operate within day-to-day decision-making processes.

The AIMS Guard Accountability Trigger Framework (ATF) proposes a practical governance model based on a simple premise:

Enhanced accountability should become mandatory when predefined risk conditions are met.

Rather than applying the same level of governance to every action, decision or system event, ATF introduces the concept of an Accountability Trigger. When predefined risk signals are detected, the framework requires governance intervention before progression can continue.

The purpose of this approach is to transform accountability from a policy objective into an observable governance activity.

When an Accountability Trigger is activated, three governance outputs become mandatory:

- Human Oversight - Documented Rationale - Audit Evidence

Together, these outputs create reviewable evidence demonstrating that governance intervention occurred and that responsibility remained attached to identifiable decision-makers.

The framework is intentionally technology agnostic and may be applied across multiple domains, including AI governance, public sector decision-making, healthcare, financial services, autonomous systems and organisational governance workflows.

To demonstrate practical implementation, the framework has been operationalised through the AIMS Guard Accountability Trigger Engine (ATE), the first reference implementation of ATF.

ATE demonstrates how Accountability Triggers can be operationalised through observable governance controls including risk detection, governance review workflows, human approval requirements and audit evidence generation within AI-assisted software development environments.

ATF does not prescribe specific technologies, regulations or implementation methods. Instead, it provides a governance structure that organisations can adapt to their own operational, regulatory and risk environments.



Reference Implementation: AIMS Guard Accountability Trigger Engine (ATE)

- ❑ Automated risk signal detection
- ❑ Accountability Trigger activation
- ❑ Human governance review requirements
- ❑ Audit evidence generation

Key Principle

"Accountability should be activated through observable governance controls that create reviewable evidence."

About the Author

Japmandeep Ahluwalia (Sunny) is the Founder of Luxyn Ethics & Governance (LEG) and an AI governance practitioner focused on translating accountability, human oversight and risk management principles into practical governance controls.

He developed the AIMS Guard Accountability Trigger Framework (ATF) and its first reference implementation, the AIMS Guard Accountability Trigger Engine (ATE), as part of his work in Responsible AI and AI Governance.

